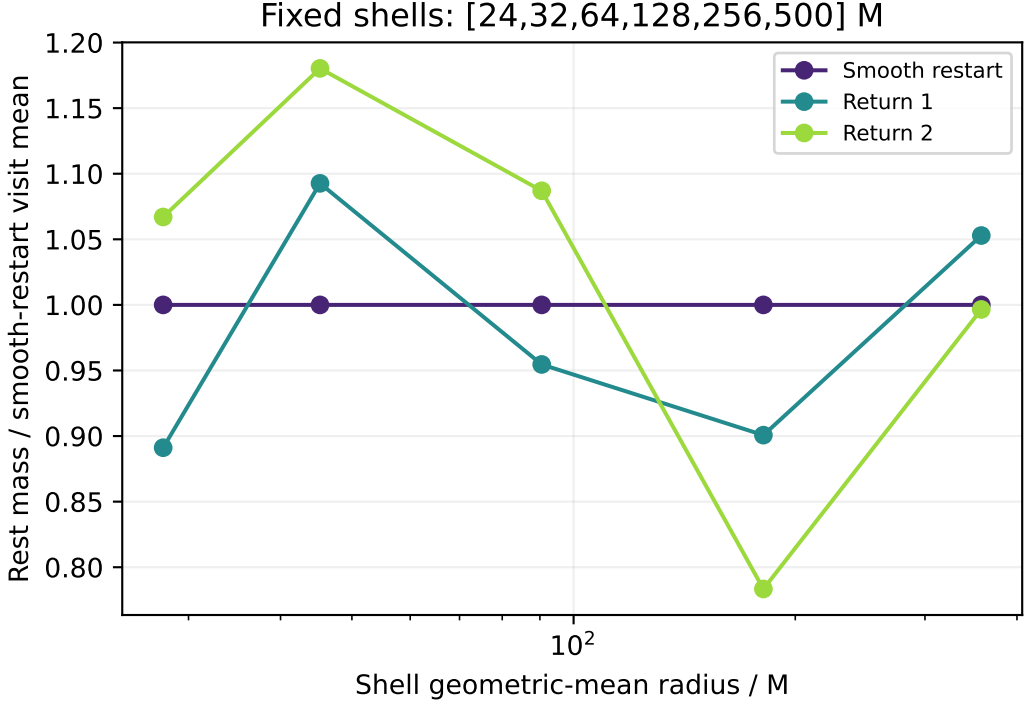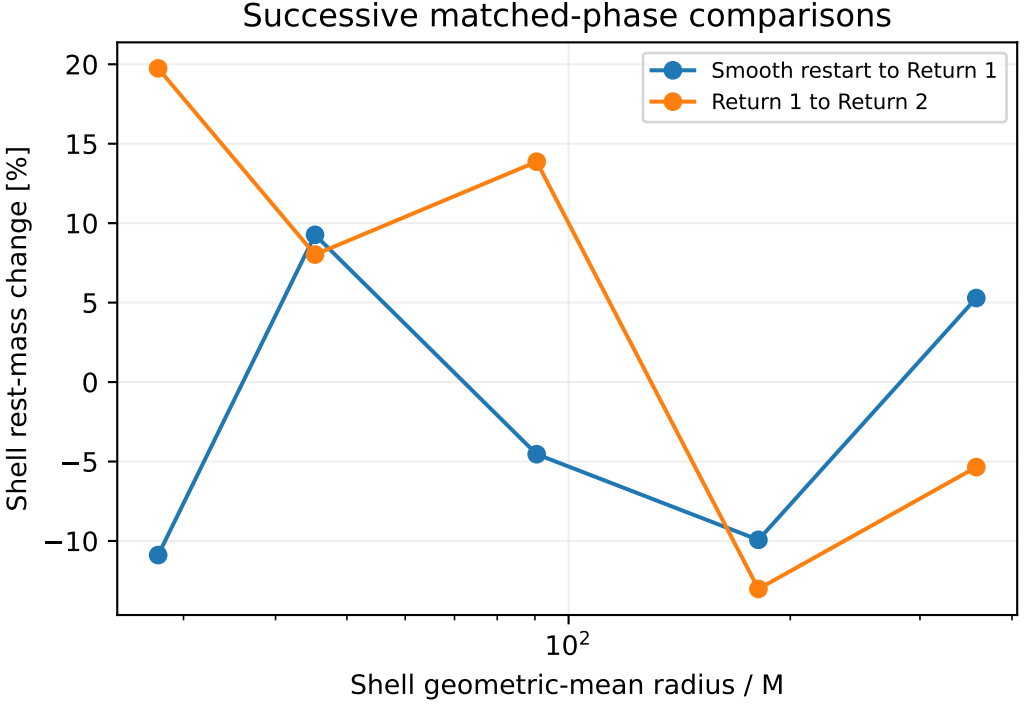Identical finest-stage topology; no continuous conservation residual across frozen intervals